

Incident Case Report Template

1. Case Information

- **Case ID:** 001
- **Case Title:** powershell.exe on DESKTOP-44AO68N
- **Date / Time of Detection:** Sep. 12, 2025 08:54:20 (2025-09-12 06:54:20 UTC)
- **Reported by:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Alert)
- **Case Owner:** Ali YILMAZ

2. Incident Summary

- **Description of the Incident:**
A PowerShell process downloaded a remote file under a productivity application. This is often the result of a malicious macro designed to drop a variety of second stage payloads. Investigate the process tree.
- **Initial Alert Source:**
CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Alert)
- **Classification:**
Initial Access via Spearphishing Attachment
- **Severity Level:** High

3. Investigation Details

3.1 Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

- **IP Addresses:** None
- **Domains / URLs:** https://falcon.eu-1.crowdstrike.com/activity-v2/detections/74a413757adc45e9a7182da65337c8a8:ind:bf6088836b9446deb5f85dbf64be3f2b:81838496577-10279-789776?_cid=g050007phnbydhbjbnrd2ayceym7hnhm
- **File Hashes:**
- 9785001b0dcf755eddb8af294a373c0b87b2498660f724e76c4d53f9c217c7a3

3.2 OSINT & Threat Intelligence Findings

- **VirusTotal:** Matches rule PowerShell Core DLL Loaded By Non PowerShell Process by Tom Kern, oscd.community, Natalia Shornikova, Tim Shelton, Roberto

Rodriguez (Cyb3rWard0g), OTR (Open Threat Research) at Sigma Integrated Rule Set (GitHub)

Detects loading of essential DLLs used by PowerShell, but not by the process powershell.exe. Detects behaviour similar to meterpreter's "load powershell" extension.

- **JoeSandBox:** The malware executes as a PowerShell executable (`powershell.exe`) located in an unusual directory (`C:\Users\user\Desktop\`) rather than the standard system location. This placement is likely intended to bypass Host-based Intrusion Prevention Systems (HIPS) that may have allowlists for legitimate system binaries in their standard locations.

4. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic (Category)	Technique (ID & Name)	Evidence in Case
Initial Access	T1566.001 (Spearphishing Attachment) → <i>CrowdStrike EDR alert shows suspicious PowerShell spawned from document process</i>	[Yes]
Execution	T1204 (User Execution) → <i>PowerShell executed by user interaction</i>	[No]
Persistence	T1547 – Boot or Logon Autostart Execution	[No]
Privilege Escalation	...	...
Defense Evasion	...	...
Credential Access	T1110 – Brute Force	[No]
Discovery	...	...
Lateral Movement	...	...
Collection	...	...
Exfiltration	...	...

Tactic (Category)	Technique (ID & Name)	Evidence in Case
Command and Control (C2)	T1071 – Application Layer Protocol	[No]

(Fill only relevant ones, mark N/A if not applicable)

5. Timeline of Events

Time (UTC)	Event Description	Source (Log/Alert)	Notes
[Sep. 12, 2025 08:54:20 (2025-09-12 06:54:20 UTC)]	Detection of alert	CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Alert)	...
[2025-09-12]	Analyst OSINT check started	VirusTotal - Joesandbox	...
[(2025-09-12]	Escalation / Ticket created	#6303 TheHive	...

6. Result & Assessment

- **Final Verdict:** [True Positive]
- **Impact Assessment:**
 - Affected Users/Hosts: [DESKTOP-44AO68N]
 - Business Impact: [High] Potential malware execution and data exfiltration risk

7. Recommended Actions

- **Technical Actions (SOC):**
 - Block IP/domain on firewall/proxy
 - Quarantine affected host(s)
 - Review SIEM logs for correlation

- **Organizational / HR Actions:**
 - Notify HR if policy violation (e.g., gambling, unauthorized sites)
 - Awareness training for user(s)

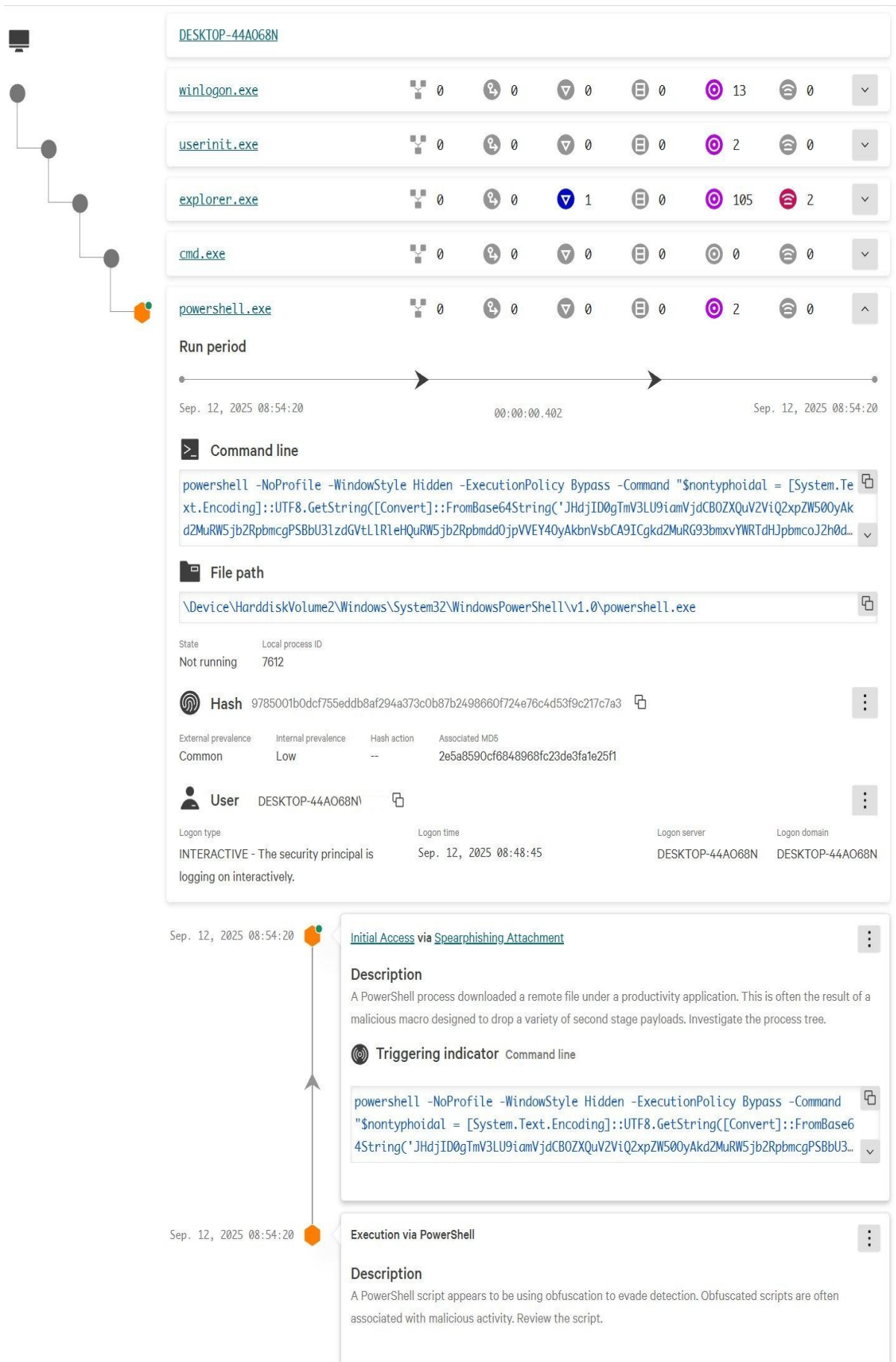
8. Case Closure

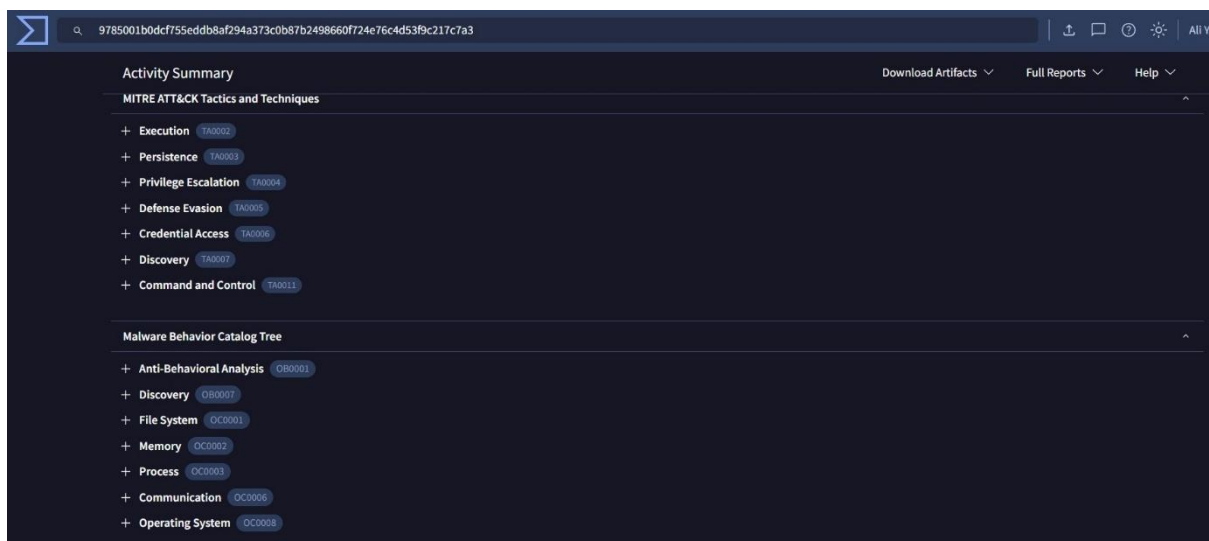
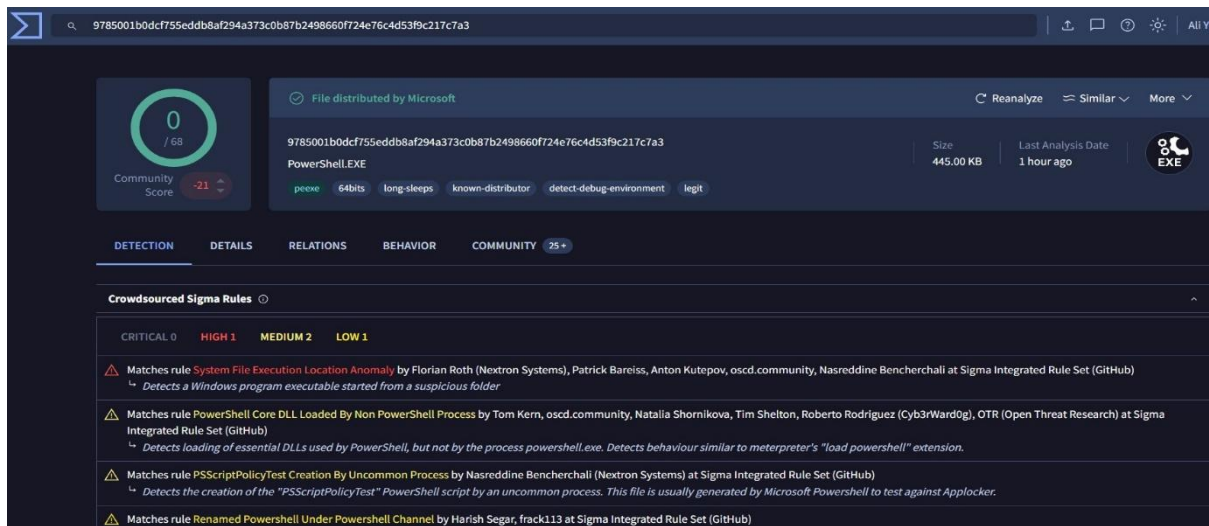
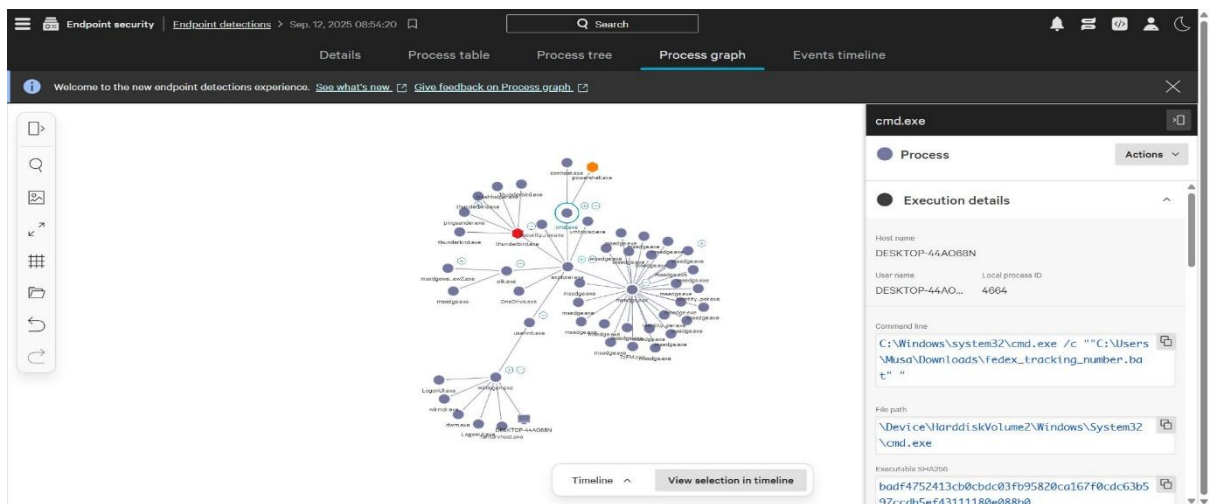
- **Closure Date:** Sep. 12, 2025 13:00
- **Closed by:** Ali YILMAZ
- **Case Status:** Closed

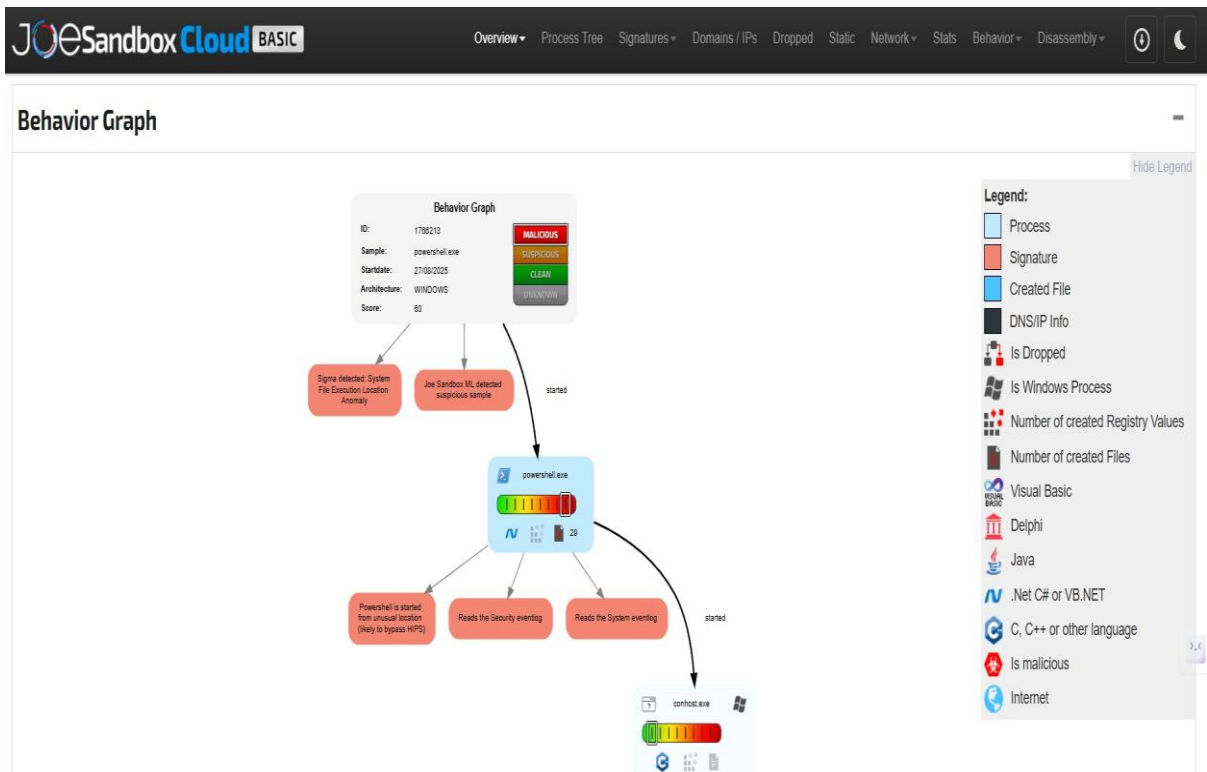
Screenshots:

The screenshot displays the Endpoint Security interface for a process named **powershell.exe** on host **DESKTOP-44A068N**. The interface is divided into several sections:

- Tags:** Shows a tag **[true_positive]**.
- Description:** A PowerShell process downloaded a remote file under a productivity application. This is often the result of a malicious macro designed to drop a variety of second stage payloads. Investigate the process tree.
- Summary:**
 - Severity: **High**
 - Process: **powershell.exe**
 - Tactic & technique: **Initial Access via SpearphishingAttachment**
 - Start time: **Sep. 12, 2025 08:54:28**
 - End time: **Sep. 12, 2025 08:54:28**
 - Assigned to: **Ali YILMAZ**
 - Status: **Closed**
- Full details:**
 - Process:** Shows the process tree, including **powershell.exe** and **PowerShell.exe**. It also shows the process's parent process, **PowerShell.exe**, and the process's child process, **PowerShell.exe**.
 - Hash:** Shows the SHA-256 hash of the file: **978500b0d0c7f55dddbaf264a97b0d0754e76d83f6217c73**.
 - Activity:** Shows the process's activity, including **Process killed** and **Process started**.
 - File:** Shows the file's details, including the file name, size, and type.
 - Host:** Shows the host's details, including the host name, IP address, and operating system.
 - User:** Shows the user's details, including the user name, user ID, and user type.
 - Process actions:** Shows the actions taken on the process, including **Process killed** and **Process started**.
 - Status log:** Shows the status log, including the status, assigned to, and assigned user.







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Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment

TECHNIQUES

- Spearphishing Attachment**
- Spearphishing Link
- Spearphishing via Service
- Spearphishing Voice
- Replication Through Removable Media
- Supply Chain Compromise
- Trusted Relationship
- Valid Accounts
- Wi-Fi Networks
- Execution
- Persistence
- Privilege Escalation

Other sub-techniques of Phishing (4)

Adversaries may send spearphishing emails with a malicious attachment in an attempt to gain access to victim systems. Spearphishing attachment is a specific variant of spearphishing. Spearphishing attachment is different from other forms of spearphishing in that it employs the use of malware attached to an email. All forms of spearphishing are electronically delivered social engineering targeted at a specific individual, company, or industry. In this scenario, adversaries attach a file to the spearphishing email and usually rely upon [User Execution](#) to gain execution.^[1] Spearphishing may also involve social engineering techniques, such as posing as a trusted source.

There are many options for the attachment such as Microsoft Office documents, executables, PDFs, or archived files. Upon opening the attachment (and potentially clicking past protections), the adversary's payload exploits a vulnerability or directly executes on the user's system. The text of the spearphishing email usually tries to give a plausible reason why the file should be opened, and may explain how to bypass system protections in order to do so. The email may also contain instructions on how to decrypt an attachment, such as a zip file password, in order to evade email boundary defenses. Adversaries frequently manipulate file extensions and icons in order to make attached executables appear to be document files, or files exploiting one application appear to be a file for a different one.

ID: T1566.001

Sub-technique of: T1566

Tactic: Initial Access

Platforms: Linux, Windows, macOS

Contributors: Philip Winther

Version: 2.2

Created: 02 March 2020

Last Modified: 15 April 2025

[Version Permalink](#)